

Criterion B: Planning



Criteria B (4 marks) is part of the project blueprint. Criterion B is your high-level project management plan: decomposing the problem and scheduling the work.

Criterion B: Your Project Blueprint

This page covers the *planning* phase of your project. This section helps to form the blueprint that you will follow during development.

- **Criterion B (Planning):** The "who, what, when" of project management.

Criterion B: The Project Plan (4 Marks)

Goal: To show *how* you will manage the project by breaking down the problem and creating a timeline.

Recommended Word Count: ~150 words

1. Decomposition

This is the first and most important part of planning. You must **break down the complex problem** you defined in Criterion A into smaller, more manageable sub-problems or components.

- This is a core part of computational thinking.
- A "reasonable decomposition" (the key phrase from the rubric) breaks the problem into its essential components and shows you understand the full scope of the project.
- You can show this using diagrams, a bulleted list, or a mind map.

2. The Plan

Once you have your components, you must create a **chronological plan (timeline)**. This plan must cover all phases of the project:

1. Planning
2. Designing
3. Developing
4. Testing
5. Evaluating

Tool for the Job: Gantt Chart

- The TSM (p. 69) suggests using a **Gantt chart** to show this visually.
- A Gantt chart is perfect for mapping out your tasks, their dependencies, and the time you'll allocate to each one.
- Your plan must be specific to *your* project and address your success criteria. A generic plan will not score well.

Common Pitfall:

- Your plan must be written *before* you start developing. It is a plan for future work, **not a development journal** of work you've already completed.

Essential approaches:

- A generic Gantt chart will not be enough to fulfil the criterion which means it must include:
 - Tasks and sub-tasks
 - Consider dependencies and relationships between tasks.
 - Build in and document research time into each sub-task.
- The IB states that you must take an **AGILE** approach.

What does taking an AGILE approach mean?



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